

Use-case definition

Describe one candidate use case: what it is, why it matters, which data it needs and what it will change. Fill in one form for each candidate. The answers feed the scorecard (step 2).

Use case
Define 1 · Describe it

Scorecard
Define 2 · Score it

Prioritisation
Define 3 · Choose

BRD or PRD
Define 4 · Require it

TDD
Design · Next stage

Worked example. UC-SALES-001 is the use case behind the sales_performance example product. Answers come from BRD-SALES-002 where it has them; fields marked Illustrative are invented for the example.

USE-CASE ID
UC-SALES-001

TITLE
Sales performance insight

BUSINESS DOMAIN
Sales

PROPOSED BY **ILLUSTRATIVE**
Head of Sales Operations

DATE **ILLUSTRATIVE**
2026-08-03

VERSION
1.0

STATUS
☐ Candidate ☐ Scored ☒ Approved ☐ Deferred ☐ Rejected

1 Description

What is it about? Two or three sentences that tell a reader quickly what it is.

Give sales leadership one consistent view of which customer segments, products and regions are growing. The figures must match how Finance reports revenue and how Merchandising defines the product range, and must be fresh enough to reallocate leads during the working day.

2 Justification

Why do it? Refer to the SWOT analysis and list the items this use case addresses: internal strengths (S) and weaknesses (W), external opportunities (O) and threats (T).

S, W, O or T	Item in the SWOT analysis	How this use case addresses it
W	Sales, Finance and Merchandising report different figures for the same period	One measure of net sales that reconciles with Finance's revenue and uses Merchandising's product range
W	Sales Operations work from a stale picture, which causes duplicate customer outreach	Figures refreshed through the working day
S	One system of record already holds every order, customer and product	Builds on that system instead of collecting new data
O	An external analytics partner can add insight if it receives regular figures	A monthly extract with no customer detail

3 Classification

What is its purpose? Tick all that apply.

- ☐ New product or service
- ☒ Improve operations for example design, development or production
- ☒ Improve intelligence know more about the market, customers, partners, competitors or ourselves
- ☐ Productise data for example aggregated customer data or demographics
- ☐ Enhance company valuation for example data security or brand reputation

4 Business questions

Which questions will it answer, who asks them, and which decisions will the answers support? If the use case is approved, these become the first section of the BRD or PRD.

Question	Who asks it	Decision it supports
Which customer segments drove net sales growth this period?	Sales leadership, Sales Operations	Quarterly segment investment allocation
Which products and regions are growing or declining?	Sales leadership, Merchandising	Range and territory planning
What makes up a given period's net sales figure?	Sales Operations, Finance	Variance investigation and month-end reconciliation

5 Data landscape

Which data does it need, and what state is that data in? This section drives the data readiness score.

Existing data

Which data do we already hold? Use the data asset register.

The sales system of record holds orders, order lines, customers, products and sales reps.

More data ILLUSTRATIVE

What more data of the same type do we need?

None expected.

Better data

What data of a different type would suit it better? For example structured records in place of documents.

None needed. The data is already held as structured records.

Improved data

Is the existing data consistent, with one source of truth? Must it be correct, or is good enough acceptable? Which source is reliable or preferred?

Net sales must agree with Finance's revenue, and product categories with Merchandising's range. The figures must be correct, not just good enough, because they are used for month-end reconciliation.

Availability ILLUSTRATIVE

Can we count on the data staying available?

The system of record is expected to stay in service.

Velocity

How fast does the data arrive and change?

Roughly 40,000 order lines a day. Leads are reallocated through the day, so the figures must be fresh during the working day.

6 Organisational changes

What will it change? Say what it affects, not how to do it.

Infrastructure

Which company systems does it affect, and how much change do they need?

Read access to the sales system of record, and a new place to publish the figures.

Data governance

Which data governance rules are new, changed or removed?

Shared definitions of customer and product, agreed with Finance and Merchandising.

Access

Who gains or loses access to which data?

General analysts must not see customer contact details. The external partner receives a monthly extract and no access to internal systems.

Data culture and skills ILLUSTRATIVE

Do people need new skills or training?

About 120 people will use the figures several times a day. They need a short briefing on the shared definitions.

Organisation structure ILLUSTRATIVE

Do any teams or roles change?

No change.

7 Customer and partner impact

Customer impact

How will customers be affected: products, services, the way they buy? Will it inconvenience or delight them? Will it bring new customers, or new types of customer?

Indirect. Customers receive fewer duplicate contacts from the sales team.

Partner impact

Suppliers, resellers, call centres and other partners. Do data agreements with other businesses change? Are there new opportunities?

The external analytics partner receives a monthly extract of net sales by month, product category and region, without customer detail.

8 Investment

Estimate to an order of magnitude; the implementation plan holds the detail. These answers drive the two investment scores.

Financial investment ILLUSTRATIVE

☐ Under 10k ☒ 10k to 100k ☐ 100k to 1M ☐ Over 1M

Currency and notes ILLUSTRATIVE

Order-of-magnitude estimate

Time to implement ILLUSTRATIVE

☐ Under 1 month ☐ 1 to 3 months ☒ 3 to 6 months
☐ 6 to 12 months ☐ Over 12 months

Notes

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9 Benefits ILLUSTRATIVE

What will we gain? This complements the justification. Use business terms: profit, cost savings, revenue, company valuation, or indirect gains such as customer satisfaction.

Benefit	Type: profit, cost, revenue, valuation or indirect	How we will measure it	Rough size
Better segment investment decisions each quarter	revenue	Share of growth from the segments chosen for investment	To be estimated
Less time reconciling sales and finance figures	cost	Hours spent on month-end reconciliation	To be estimated
Fewer duplicate customer contacts	indirect	Duplicate outreach incidents per month	To be estimated

10 Risks and dependencies

What could stop or delay it? Does it depend on another use case, team or supplier? Include legal and privacy concerns. This section drives the delivery risk score.

Finance and Merchandising must agree the shared definitions. We do not yet know how often the sales system can be read, or whether it keeps a history of segment changes.

Submission

Role	Name	Signature	Date
Proposed by	Head of Sales Operations		
Reviewed by			

Next: Score the use case with the other candidates in the scorecard (step 2).